

Life of a Deal — How the system works

Central Millwork
Draft for review · Aug 2026
CEO · PM · Chali

A plain-language overview for leadership. Every box is numbered so it's easy to point at and change.

1

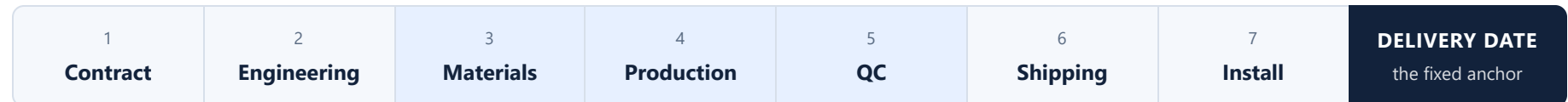
The one idea

Every project has **one delivery date**. The system works **backward** from it to figure out what must happen and by when — and it **warns before** a deadline slips, instead of explaining after.

Today this lives in spreadsheets that never find out what actually happened. The system connects the plan to reality.

2

The journey — from signed contract to delivery



← the system calculates every deadline from the delivery date, backward →

TARGET RULE **TO CONFIRM**

≤ 2 weeks

From **contract signed** to **handed off to purchasing**.

TARGET RULE **TO CONFIRM**

≤ 4 weeks

From **material in the shop** to **shipped** (fabrication + finishing + shipping).

Blue phases (Materials · Production · QC) are the ones the system already measures today. The two rules above are commitments to lock in — they set the pace of the whole schedule.

3

The project is alive — it re-plans by itself

Something real happens

material arrives · a piece is finished · a vendor slips



The system recalculates

every downstream date moves automatically



Traffic light updates

ON TRACK

TIGHT

AT RISK

The delivery date never moves on its own. If we're going to miss it, the project turns red — moving the date is a human decision that gets recorded (who, why, how many days).

4

The system holds the line — 8 hard stops

- **Contract signed** — the clock doesn't start without it
- **MTO released** — purchasing can't quote before drawings are approved
- **Release to production** — needs approved, stamped drawings
- **QC passed · Delivery request · Site ready · Punch list**

★ Production Intake — the big one

Production does not start until all five are green:

Samples approved

Drawings approved

Release done

CNC files

Material 100%

The one that arrives last is named — no more "I sent the drawings" vs "the material never came."

5

Accountability — who holds the ball, and where days are lost

- At any moment, the system shows which phase is active and who it's waiting on.
- When something finishes late, it records **who** the delay belongs to.

At year end, one report answers "**why did we deliver late?**" with numbers, not opinions:

Client · GC · Vendor · Estimating · Engineering · Procurement · Production · Logistics · Field · Finance

6

The client watches their own project

- A private link — no account needed — shows the client their timeline and what it's waiting on.
- They **approve drawings, samples and sign-off** right there; the date and person are captured automatically.
- Automatic reminders when the ball is in their court — with the impact on the delivery date spelled out.

The client never sees costs, margins, vendors or pricing.

This turns "waiting on the client" from a black hole into a dated, accountable fact.

7

What we build first — honest scope

STAGE 1 — ALREADY UNDERWAY

The engine + the phases the system already measures (Materials, Production, QC) + the auto-generated **3-Week Lookahead**. Half the journey, live, from the start.

THEN, IN ORDER

Client portal → Engineering (drawings, CNC, release) → Field & Install on mobile → Contract intake → Financial close-out.

The office areas that work outside the system today (Estimating, Engineering, Field) are where most delays happen. Bringing that work in is the real decision behind this project — not the software.

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